

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 28

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1. Abeyance

Meaning: A temporary pause, suspension, or delay.

Tip to remember: Think of something being kept “away” for now. In abeyance means held back temporarily.

Sentence: The project was held in abeyance until more funding arrived.

2. Abstract

Meaning: Theoretical or not concrete; also, a summary of a paper.

Tip to remember: Abstract ideas cannot be touched, like justice or freedom.

Sentence: The professor explained the abstract concept with a simple example.

3. Affront

Meaning: An insult or offensive act.

Tip to remember: Think of someone insulting you directly in front of everyone. That is an affront.

Sentence: His rude comment was an affront to the whole team.

4. Agitate

Meaning: To disturb, upset, or stir up.

Tip to remember: Think of shaking a bottle. You agitate the liquid inside; words can agitate people too.

Sentence: The unfair decision agitated the students.

5. August

Meaning: Respected, impressive, and dignified.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: august does not only mean the month. It can mean majestic and respected.

Sentence: The august professor was admired by scholars around the world.

6. Burnish

Meaning: To polish or improve the appearance or reputation of something.

Tip to remember: Think of polishing metal until it shines. Burnish means to make shine.

Sentence: The award helped burnish the university’s reputation.

7. **Coy**
Meaning: Pretending to be shy or unwilling to give information.
Tip to remember: Think of someone smiling but not answering directly. That person is being coy.
Sentence: The manager was coy about the company's future plans.
8. **Deprecate**
Meaning: To express disapproval of; to criticize mildly; to belittle.
Tip to remember: Deprecate sounds like "decrease praise." You reduce the value of something.
Sentence: She deprecated her own achievements even though they were impressive.
9. **Disdain**
Meaning: Strong dislike or disrespect for something considered inferior.
Tip to remember: Think of looking down on someone with cold dislike. That feeling is disdain.
Sentence: He showed disdain for people who cheated.
10. **Disperse**
Meaning: To scatter or spread in different directions.
Tip to remember: Think of people leaving a crowd and spreading everywhere. They disperse.
Sentence: The police asked the crowd to disperse.
11. **Distend**
Meaning: To swell or expand because of pressure from inside.
Tip to remember: Distend sounds like "extend." A balloon distends when air extends it outward.
Sentence: The patient's stomach began to distend after the meal.
12. **Endemic**
Meaning: Regularly found in a particular place or group.
Tip to remember: Think of a disease or plant that belongs to one local area. That is endemic.
Sentence: Corruption had become endemic in the organization.
13. **Enmity**
Meaning: Deep hostility or hatred.
Tip to remember: Enmity sounds like enemy. Enmity is the feeling between enemies.
Sentence: Years of conflict created enmity between the two groups.
14. **Gauche**
Meaning: Socially awkward or lacking tact.
Tip to remember: Think of someone saying the wrong thing at a formal dinner. That is gauche.
Sentence: His gauche joke made everyone uncomfortable.

15. **Hysterical**
Meaning: Extremely emotional or uncontrollably upset; also, very funny.
Tip to remember: Think of someone laughing or crying without control. That is hysterical.
Sentence: She became hysterical after hearing the shocking news.
16. **Impudent**
Meaning: Rude and disrespectful, especially toward authority.
Tip to remember: Impudent sounds like “improper student.” An impudent student talks rudely to the teacher.
Sentence: The impudent reply angered the professor.
17. **Inchoate**
Meaning: Not fully developed; just beginning.
Tip to remember: Think of an idea still in its early, incomplete shape. That is inchoate.
Sentence: His inchoate research idea needed more structure.
18. **Penchant**
Meaning: A strong liking or tendency toward something.
Tip to remember: Penchant sounds like “passion.” If you have a penchant for something, you naturally like it.
Sentence: She has a penchant for solving difficult puzzles.
19. **Quandary**
Meaning: A state of uncertainty about what to do.
Tip to remember: Think of asking, “What should I do?” again and again. That mental confusion is a quandary.
Sentence: He was in a quandary about whether to accept the job offer.
20. **Quarantine**
Meaning: To isolate someone or something to prevent the spread of disease or danger.
Tip to remember: Think of keeping a sick person separate from others. That is quarantine.
Sentence: The infected animals were placed in quarantine.
21. **Quash**
Meaning: To suppress, reject, or put an end to something.
Tip to remember: Quash sounds like “squash.” To quash a rumor is to squash it completely.
Sentence: The court quashed the unfair decision.
22. **Quibble**
Meaning: To argue about small or unimportant details.
Tip to remember: Think of someone wasting time fighting over tiny points. That is quibbling.
Sentence: They quibbled over minor wording instead of solving the main issue.

23. **Ravage**
Meaning: To severely damage or destroy.
Tip to remember: Ravage sounds like savage. A savage storm can ravage a village.
Sentence: The flood ravaged the lowland settlements.
24. **Recant**
Meaning: To publicly withdraw or take back a statement or belief.
Tip to remember: Recant sounds like “re-cancel.” You cancel what you said before.
Sentence: The witness was forced to recant his earlier statement.
25. **Redoubtable**
Meaning: Formidable, impressive, and deserving respect or fear.
Tip to remember: Redoubtable sounds like “double doubt.” You doubt whether you can defeat such a powerful person.
Sentence: The redoubtable lawyer rarely lost a case.
26. **Retiring**
Meaning: Shy, quiet, and not wanting attention.
Tip to remember: A retiring person mentally retires from the spotlight.
Sentence: Although brilliant, he was retiring and avoided public praise.
27. **Shrill**
Meaning: High-pitched and unpleasantly loud; harsh in tone.
Tip to remember: Think of a sharp whistle hurting your ears. That sound is shrill.
Sentence: Her shrill voice echoed through the hallway.
28. **Sophistry**
Meaning: Clever but false reasoning used to deceive.
Tip to remember: Sophistry sounds like sophisticated trickery. It looks smart but is logically false.
Sentence: The argument sounded impressive, but it was pure sophistry.
29. **Substantiate**
Meaning: To support or prove with evidence.
Tip to remember: Substantiate contains substance. Evidence gives substance to a claim.
Sentence: The researcher used data to substantiate her conclusion.
30. **Wily**
Meaning: Clever at tricking or deceiving others.
Tip to remember: Think of a wily fox escaping every trap.
Sentence: The wily businessman avoided responsibility through clever excuses.